

St. Albert to discuss asking province to pause disability support program



[Tristan Oram](#)

May 11, 2026 5:30 PM



The provincial government announced ADAP last year. FILE PHOTO/St. Albert Gazette

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St. Albert will soon decide whether to join other municipalities in calls to pause changes to disability benefits programs that will take effect on July 1.

Coun. Amanda Patrick has submitted a notice of motion that if passed, would see St. Albert call on the province to pause the implementation of the Alberta Disability Assistance Program (ADAP) and to undertake consultation with the disability advocacy organizations and municipalities.

Other municipalities like Edmonton, Red Deer, Camrose, and Calgary have passed or are in discussions to pass similar motions.

"The City of St. Albert should follow the lead of other municipalities and show our disabled community that we support them, that we understand the added stress and anxiety, and financial stress that this program could potentially have on them," Patrick said.

The changes would see Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped (AISH) users transferred into ADAP, the province's replacement. AISH users who are transferred to ADAP will receive \$200 less each month. There are currently more than 77,000 AISH users.

Patrick said she's not sure how much consultation was done on the province's behalf, but said that the loss of income could put pressure on local organizations like Family and Community Support Services (FCSS) and the St. Albert Food Bank.

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Chelsea Southam, communications advisor for the City of St. Albert and FCSS, said the city wouldn't be able to comment until after Patrick's motion is debated.

Local food bank executive director Suzan Krecsy said the organization is bracing for an increase in food bank usage now and a possible increase in evictions as people may no longer be able to meet their rent.

Amber Edgerton, press secretary for the Minister of Assisted Living and Social Services said in an email that the criticism is unfounded.

"Municipalities are advocating against a program that will help thousands of Albertans with disabilities pursue meaningful employment while continuing to receive the financial, health and personal supports they need," Edgerton said.

Patrick also questioned if there were available and accessible jobs for individuals moved from AISH to ADAP, given the province's unemployment rate moved up to seven per cent in April. Ultimately,

she hopes St. Albert will join the chorus of some other municipalities and their calls to the province when council is expected to vote on Tuesday, May 19.

"I just think we should be showing support to our disabled community."



About the Author: Tristan Oram

Tristan Oram joined the St. Albert Gazette in December 2024. He studied journalism at Mount Royal University in Calgary. He currently covers St. Albert city council.

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LA

[Leah Aych](#) May 11, 2026 7:16 PM

This government needs to give their heads a shake. Like most things, they haven't consulted with disability groups, hence why advocates are protesting this decision. Further, they are quickly dividing our province in more ways than one, including creating citizen groups composed of the "haves" and the "have nots."

CB

[Cheryl Brodgesell](#) May 11, 2026 7:56 PM

I don't understand what there is to decide or discuss, just do it. The most vulnerable of our population count on the municipalities to look out for them. I would think St. Albert would just step up and do it. I am disappointed that this is not already happening. Shame on St. Albert council for both being the front runners in this.

FS

[Farmer's Son](#) May 12, 2026 7:06 AM

Unfortunately, social services is a provincial government responsibility, and the UCP aren't looking after the vulnerable in Alberta.

CB

[Cheryl Brodgesell](#) May 11, 2026 7:59 PM

My previous comment should read "Shame on St. Albert council for NOT being the front runners in this.

FS

[Farmer's Son](#) May 12, 2026 7:07 AM

ADAP is another heartless move by the UCP and Danielle Smith. Their rich friends matter more.

JM

[Jack McMurphy](#) May 13, 2026 11:51 AM

All this government does is strips vulnerable people of their needs. Like come on.
